

ART AND CULTURE



RELIGION AND PHILOSOPHY

BHAKTI MOVEMENT

- IMPORTANT PREACHERS

MODULE – 11



IMPORTANT PREACHERS IN THE BHAKTI MOVEMENT

5

JNANESHWAR

Late 13th century CE; Maharashtra



- A **saint poet in Maharashtra** and early reformist. He was also a philosopher and a yogi of the Nath tradition.
- His **commentary on Bhagvad Gita** called **Jnaneshwari** and another work **Amrut-Anubhav** are important contributions in Marati literature
- Emphasised on 'Bhakti' and equality of all beings and **condemned the caste system**
- Belonged to the **Varkari tradition** (A Bhakti tradition in Maharashtra and Karnataka where **Lord Vishnu is worshipped in his incarnation as Vitthal or Vithoba**).

IMPORTANT PREACHERS IN THE BHAKTI MOVEMENT

6

NAMDEVA

Late 13th and 14th century CE; Maharashtra,
northern Karnataka



- He was a poet and saint of the **Varkari** tradition.
- He was a **Vaishnavite** and his preachings included the Nirguna as well as Saguna elements.
- Preached and composed in local **Marathi** language.

Varkari or Warkari (meaning "a pilgrim") is a sampradaya (religious movement) within the bhakti spiritual tradition of Vaishnavite Hinduism, geographically associated with the Indian state of Maharashtra.

IMPORTANT PREACHERS IN THE BHAKTI MOVEMENT

7

RAMANANDA

Part of the 14th and 15th century CE; Varanasi region of Uttar Pradesh.



MCQ ALERT!

Please remember the disciples of Ramananda and Vallabhacharya.

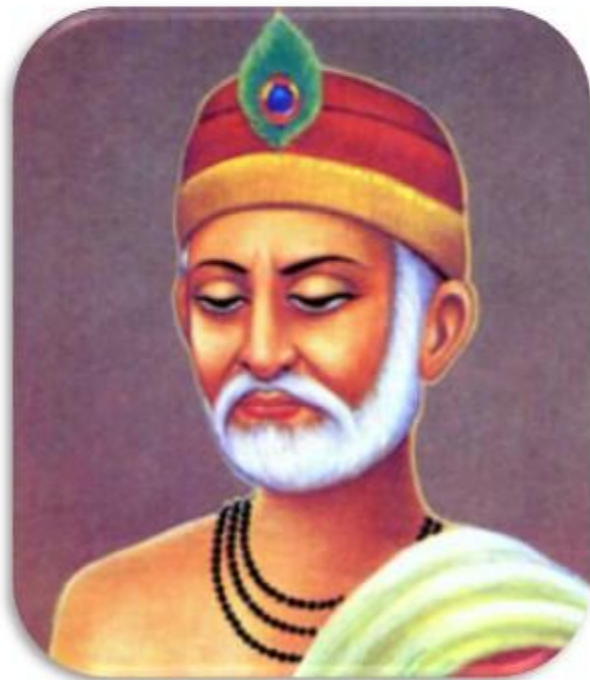
- Founder of the **Ramanandi Sampraday**, one of the largest monastic Hindu order.
- Prominent preacher of Bhakti movement, a **Vaishnava** devotional poet and saint.
- Initiated 12 disciples (10 men and 2 women) which include **Kabirdas**, **Ravidas**, **Bhagat Pipa**, and others
- First to preach in **Hindi** (local language), author of **Gyanlila** and **Yoga Chintamani** (in Hindi) and other works like **Vaisanava-mata Bhajhaskara**, and **Ramcharna Paddhati** in Sanskrit
- Accepted both Sagun and Nirguna philosophies.

IMPORTANT PREACHERS IN THE BHAKTI MOVEMENT

8

KABIR

15th century CE; Varanasi, Uttar Pradesh



- A prominent poet saint of Bhakti movement and a **disciple of Ramananda**
- Questioned dogmas and rituals in both **Hinduism and Islam**, preached monism and Nirguna Brahma
- Teachings are in the form of couplets known as **Dohas**.
- Some of Kabir's couplets also find place in the Sikh **holy book Adi Granth**.
- Kabir is known for being critical of both Hinduism and Islam,

IMPORTANT PREACHERS IN THE BHAKTI MOVEMENT

8

KABIR

15th century CE; Varanasi, Uttar Pradesh



- During his lifetime, he was threatened by both Hindus and Muslims for his views
- When he died, both Hindus and Muslims had claimed him as theirs.
- Kabir's legacy survives and continues through the **Kabir panth** ("Path of Kabir"), a religious community that recognizes him as its founder.
- Its members are known as **Kabir panthis**.

IMPORTANT PREACHERS IN THE BHAKTI MOVEMENT

9

GURU NANAK

15th century CE; Punjab



MCQ ALERT!

The Year 2019 is the 550th Anniversary of Guru Nanak.

- First of the ten Sikh gurus and founder of Sikhism.
- Guru Nanak was born in **Nankana Sahib** which is in present day Punjab of Pakistan.
- Teaching based on monism, equality, love towards fellow beings, and devotion to God.
- Teaching contained in 974 verses in **Guru Granth Sahib**, as a collection of verses recorded in **Gurmukhi script** (holy text of Sikhism and compilation of teachings of various Sikh Gurus and also other preachers).
- Guru Nanak died in the year of 1539 in **Kartarpur**.

IMPORTANT PREACHERS IN THE BHAKTI MOVEMENT

10

CHAITANYA

Late 15th and 16th century CE; Bengal, but travelled and preached throughout India.



- Also referred as Chaitanya Mahaprabhu or Gaurang Mahaprabhu,
- He was a Bengali spiritual teacher & the founder of **Gaudiya Vaishnavism**.
- "Gauḍīya" refers to the Gauḍa region (present day Bengal/Bangladesh).
- Teachings were **based on Bhagvata Purana, Bhagvata Gita, and Krishna Bhakti** (devotion to Lord Krishna)
- His teachings are recorded **Siksastakam** (which contains eight devotional prayers in Sanskrit).

IMPORTANT PREACHERS IN THE BHAKTI MOVEMENT

10

CHAITANYA

Late 15th and 16th century CE; Bengal, but travelled and preached throughout India.



A murti of Chaitanya in
ISKCON temple, Mayapur

- He is believed by his devotees to be Krishna himself who appeared in the form of His own devotee in order to teach the people of this world the process of Bhakti and how to attain the perfection of life.
- He is considered as the most merciful manifestation of Krishna.
- Of various incarnations of Vishnu, he is revered as Krishna, popularised the chanting of the Hare Krishna mantra.

QUICK RELOOK AT OUR PREVIOUS MODULES

CHAITANYA'S LINK WITH PAINTING AND THEATRE FORM

INDIAN THEATRE

FOLK THEATRE

THEATRE OF ENTERTAINMENT

JATRA

- 1 Jatra is popular folk theatre of Eastern India. It is generally an open-air performance that was initiated by Vaishnava saint Sri Chaitanya.



- 2 During his travels through rural Bengal, he used the medium of Jatra to propagate the teachings of Krishna.
- 3 Later, variants such as Rama Jatra, Shiv Jatra and Chandi Jatra also came into existence that narrated stories from Puranic legends.
- 4 In the modern times, Jatra was used to narrate stories of secular, historical and even patriotic themes.
- 5 In Odisha, a popular form of street theatre known as Sahi Jatra is prevalent.

MODULE 3 - FOLK THEATRE

FOLK PAINTINGS IN INDIA

4

KALIGHAT PAINTING



CHAITANYA MAHAPRABHU

- He was a Hindu mystic, saint, and a proponent of Vaishnavism tradition within Hinduism.
- He also popularized the chanting of Hare Krishna Mantra and singing of Kirtans and Bhajans.

- 11 Among the deities that the Kalighat artists painted, the goddess Kali was a favorite. Images of Durga, Lakshmi, and Annapurna were also popular, especially during the Durga Puja festival.
- 12 Another theme depicted, dear to the Bengali ethos, was that of Chaitanya Mahaprabhu and his disciples.
- 13 Over time, these paintings were used to express social sentiments. Kalighat paintings are considered one of its kind in the country to express subaltern sentiments and address customers directly.

MODULE 8 - FOLK PAINTINGS

IMPORTANT PREACHERS IN THE BHAKTI MOVEMENT

11

NARSINH MEHTA

15th century CE; Gujarat



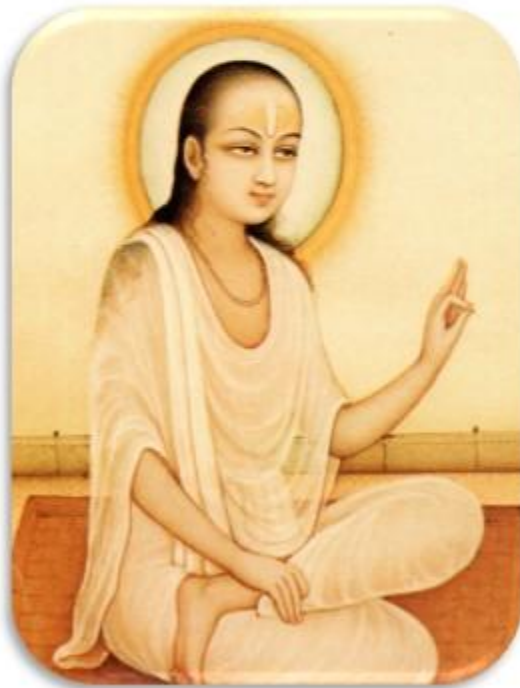
- A poet saint of Bhakti tradition who preached in Gujarat
- Composed a **number of Padas (verses)**
- He is especially revered in Gujarati literature, **where he is acclaimed as its Adi Kavi** (Sanskrit for "first among poets").
- Well known for his poem/song 'Vaishno Jan to Tene re Kahiye' which was a favourite song of Mahatma Gandhi.

IMPORTANT PREACHERS IN THE BHAKTI MOVEMENT

12

VALLABHACHARYA

15th and 16th century, born in South India. Preached throughout India. Died in Kashi, Uttar Pradesh.



- Also known as **Vallabha**, was a Hindu theologian and philosopher who founded the **Krishna-centered Pushti sect of Vaishnavism (Pushti Marg)** in the Braj region of India.
- Followers include Pushti Sampradaya and Vishnu-Swami Sampradaya.
- Vallabha **rejected asceticism and monastic life**, suggested that through loving devotion to God Krishna, **any householder could achieve salvation** – an idea that became influential in western Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan and Madhya Pradesh.

IMPORTANT PREACHERS IN THE BHAKTI MOVEMENT

13

SURDAS

15th and 16th century; Vrindavan, Mathura, Uttar Pradesh.



- Blind poet saint, dedicated in devotion to Lord Krishna
- Surdas was known for his lyrics written in praise of Lord Krishna.
- They are usually written in Braj Bhasa, one of the two literary dialects of Hindi.
- A disciple of Vallabhacharya
- His verses are contained in famous works called Sursagar, Sur-Saravali, and Sahitya Lahiri.

IMPORTANT PREACHERS IN THE BHAKTI MOVEMENT

14

RAIDAS OR RAVIDAS

15th and early 16th century; Varanasi, Uttar Pradesh



Modi on Feb 19, 2019 laid the foundation stone of the Ravidas Janmasthan area development project in Varanasi on the birth anniversary of Ravidas.

- A **disciple of Ramananda**, Ravidas, preached devotion to God, equality of mankind and removal of divides such as caste
- Some of **his verses included in Guru Granth Sahib**.
- Guru Ravidas was a North Indian mystic poet-saint of the Bhakti movement during the 14th to 16th century CE.
- Venerated as a guru (teacher) in the region of **Punjab, Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan, Maharashtra and Madhya Pradesh** the devotional songs of Ravidas made a lasting impact upon the bhakti movement.
- He was a poet-saint, social reformer and a spiritual figure.
- Ravidas **taught removal of social divisions of caste and gender, and promoted unity in the pursuit of personal spiritual freedoms.**

IMPORTANT PREACHERS IN THE BHAKTI MOVEMENT

15

SHANKARDEVA

Mid 15th and 16th century CE; Assam



MCQ ALERT!

Learn the link of Shankaradeva with the relevant dance, theatre, and music

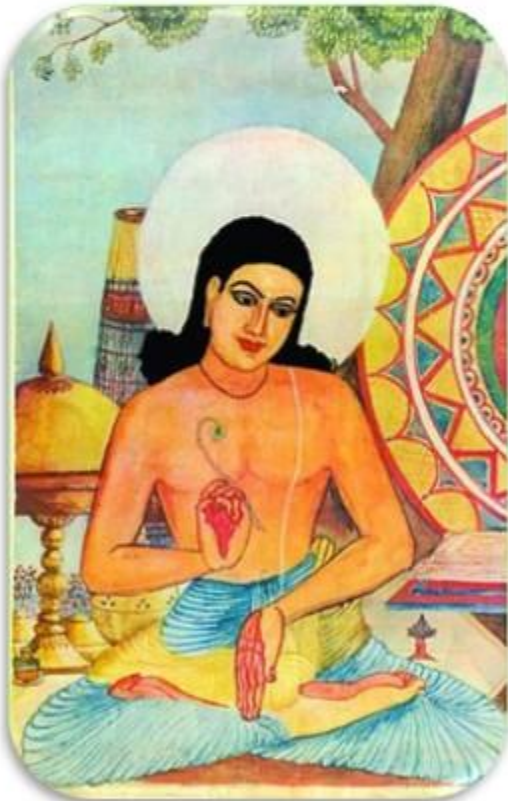
- He was a poet saint of Assam who started the **neo-Vaishnavite movement**, '**Ekasharna Dharma**', based on devotion to Lord Krishna
- Made important contribution with his poem and plays and other works including **Kirtana Ghosha**, **Borgeets** and **Harischandra Upakhyana**
- Teachings helped in **social reformation** of Hindu society in Assam.
- He is widely credited with building on past cultural relics and devising new forms of **music** (Borgeet), theatrical performance (Ankia Naat, Bhaona), dance (Sattriya), literary language (Brajavali).

IMPORTANT PREACHERS IN THE BHAKTI MOVEMENT

15

SHANKARDEVA

Mid 15th and 16th century CE; Assam



- The Bhagavatic religious movement he started, Ekasharana Dharma and also called Neo-Vaishnavite movement, influenced two medieval kingdoms—**Koch and the Ahom kingdoms**—and the assembly of devotees he initiated evolved into **Sattras** (monasteries) over time, which continue to be important socio-religious institutions in Assam.
- Sankardev inspired the Bhakti movement in Assam just as Guru Nanak, Ramananda, Namdev, Kabir, Basava and Chaitanya Mahaprabhu inspired it elsewhere in the Indian subcontinent.

IMPORTANT PREACHERS IN THE BHAKTI MOVEMENT

16

MIRABAI

16th century CE; Rajasthan



- She was a **devotee poet** steeped in Bhakti of Lord Krishna
- A princess in **Rajput dynasty**, she considered Lord Krishna as her consort and **composed many 'Padas'** to express her love and devotion.
- She referred to the Lord, whom she saw as her husband.
- Her mother, her in-laws disapproved of her public singing and dancing as she belonged to a Royal Family of Mewar and was a princess.
- But she had too much love for her god and sacrificed everything, even her family, for god and attained Moksha through Bhakti Yoga.

IMPORTANT PREACHERS IN THE BHAKTI MOVEMENT

17

TULSIDAS

16th century CE; Varanasi, Uttar Pradesh



- Also referred as **Goswami Tulsidas**, he was a poet saint and a reformer; and belonged to the Saguna school
- Follower of **Ramanandi Sampradaya** (tradition of Ramananda)
- Well known author of **Ramcharitamanas** (in Avadhi) which is a re-telling of **Sanskrit Ramayana**
- Other works include Vinay-Patrika, Hanuman-Chalisa, (hymn).
- Tulsidas spent most of his life in the city of Varanasi.
- The Tulsi Ghat on the Ganges River in Varanasi is named after him.

IMPORTANT PREACHERS IN THE BHAKTI MOVEMENT

18

EKNATH

16th century CE; Maharashtra



EKNATH ON A 2003 STAMP OF INDIA

- Poet saint in Maharashtra
- Belonged to the **Varkari tradition**; preceded by **Jnaneshwara** and **Namdev** and succeeded by **Tukaram**
- In the development of Marathi literature, Eknath is seen as a bridge between his predecessors—Jnaneshwar and Namdev—and the later Tukaram and Ramdas.
- He wrote a **variation of the Bhagavata Purana** which is known as the **Eknathi Bhagavata** and a variation of the Ramayana which is known as the **Bhavarth Ramayan**.
- He introduced a new form of Marathi religious song called **Bharood**, writing 300 of them.

IMPORTANT PREACHERS IN THE BHAKTI MOVEMENT

19

DADU DAYAL

Late 16th century CE; Gujarat



- A poet saint in Gujarat whose teachings led to formation of Dadu Panth
- 'Dadu' means brother and 'Dayal' a compassionate one. His teachings were based on devotion and compassion.
- Dadu's compositions was mostly in Braj language.
- Compositions recorded in Dadu-Anubhav Vani containing 5000 verses.

IMPORTANT PREACHERS IN THE BHAKTI MOVEMENT

20

TUKARAM

Early 17th century CE; Maharashtra



- He was a poet saint of Bhakti movement belonging to the **Vaishnavite sect (Varkari tradition)**
- His poetry (Abhanga poetry tradition) and preachings were dedicated in devotion to lord **Vithala or Vithoba** (an incarnation of Lord Vishnu).
- Tukaram is best known for his **devotional poetry called Abhanga** and **community-oriented worship** with spiritual songs known as **kirtans**.

DIVERSITY OF RELIGIOUS FAITH IN INDIA

1 India is home to numerous religions and faiths. For thousands of years, different religious communities have coexisted in peace and harmony imbued in the spirit of tolerance and universal acceptance.

2 Thus, the uniqueness of India's religious character lies in the fact that the Indian society has afforded space and acceptance to all religious faiths, irrespective of the difference in their beliefs and practices.

3 It is also irrespective of the fact whether they originated in the Indian subcontinent (as in cases Hinduism, Buddhism, Jainism, and Sikhism) or whether they came to India through religious preachers and missionaries (viz. Christianity and Islam).

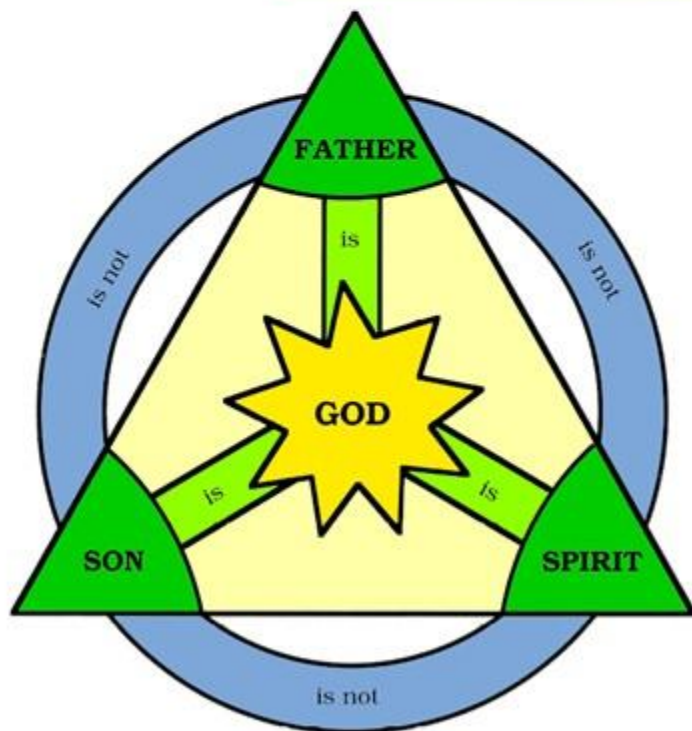
4 Even communities which came to India seeking shelter from persecution like the Zoroasters and Jews have found social acceptance and space in the Indian society.

Thus, tolerance, pluralism, and harmony have been the integral characteristics of socio-religious elements of the Indian culture.

CHRISTIANITY

Christianity originated 2000 years ago in Jerusalem and is based on the life and teachings of Jesus Christ. Today, it is the largest religion of the world with over 2.4 billion followers or roughly a third of the world's population. In India there are around 28 million Christians.

CHRISTIAN FAITH & FUNDAMENTAL BELIEFS



- 1 Christianity is a **monotheistic** religion believing in the existence of only one God.
- 2 They believe in the **Holy Trinity- the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit** (Holy Ghost).
- 3 Jesus Christ is considered as the messenger or the Son of the God.

CHRISTIANITY

CHRISTIAN FAITH & FUNDAMENTAL BELIEFS

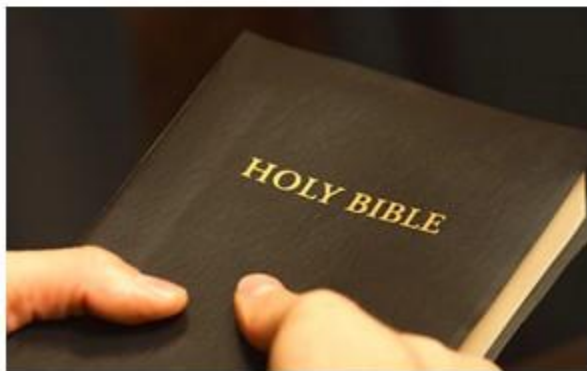


- 4 He is considered to be a **prophet in human form** who spread the message of God and was a savior of mankind.
- 5 He **endured suffering and crucifixion** to save mankind from sin and to grant salvation to those who believed in him.
- 6 Christians also consider God to be omniscient, omnipotent, omnipresent, just, loving, eternal, holy, and sinless and that He is knowable through His Son Jesus Christ.

CHRISTIANITY

SCRIPTURES IN CHRISTIANITY

- 1 The **Holy Bible** is the sacred text of Christians which comprises the **Old Testament and the New Testament**, the two major sections.
- 2 The **Old Testament** written in Hebrew text mainly **consists of rituals and offerings** and is considered to contain information about the creation of the World.



- 3 It is sacred to both Jews and Christians alike.
- 4 The **life and teachings of Jesus Christ** is contained in the **New Testament** and forms the core of the Christian faith.
- 5 The teachings of Jesus Christ are compiled from the **Gospels** (or written accounts of Jesus's life and teachings).
- 6 There are four Gospels which are considered canonical and are included in the Bible. These are Gospels of **Mathew, Mark, Luke, and John**.

CHRISTIANITY

SECTS IN CHRISTIANITY



**Martin Luther, an eminent figure
in Protestant Reformation**

- 1** Christianity is divided into several sects, the most important of which are the **Roman Catholic** and the **Protestants**.
- 2** Originally , the Christian religion was referred to as the **Catholic religion** with the **Roman Pope** as its head.
- 3** Further, in the 16th century, owing to the numerous **reforms advocated by Martin Luther**, the emergence of the **Protestant School of Christianity** took place.

CHRISTIANITY

CHRISTIANITY IN INDIA



Thomas, the Apostle

1 With nearly 28 million followers (as per 2011 Census), Christianity has the third largest following in India after Hinduism and Islam.

2 As per a particular set of scholars, Christianity has the third largest following in India after Hinduism and Islam.

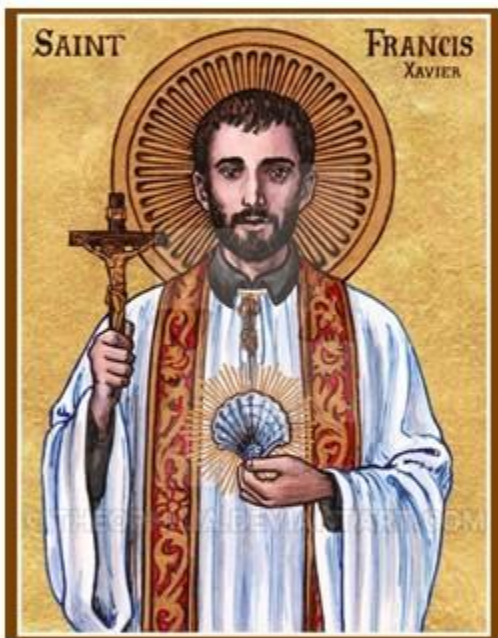
3 As per a particular set of scholars, Christianity came to India in the 1st century CE itself.

4 It is believed that Thomas the Apostle came to India in the Malabar coast in Kerala in 52 CE.

5 However, scholars generally believe that Christianity was fully established in India by the 6th century CE.

CHRISTIANITY

CHRISTIANITY IN INDIA



- 6** Concerted Christian missionary activities started in India only after the arrival of St. Francis Xavier (mid 16th century) followed by other Christian missionaries .

- 7** Substantial spread of Christianity eventually took place during the British rule, particularly in the 19th and 20th centuries.
- 8** Christians in India are followers of different sects and churches.
- 9** These include the followers of the Roman Catholic Church (in Goa, Malabar coast, and other parts), Syrian Church (mostly in South India), the Protestant Missions (parts of South India), Church of North India, and Church of South India, etc.

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